Regret gave way to relief. Joy. With a cry, she rushed into his arms. “I thought—”

André held her. “Didn’t it rain the last time we were together?”

“Yes.” She laughed. “I was waiting at the station looking for you.”

He held her tight. Reinhardt dropped into her mind, but she pushed him out. Not today. She wouldn’t allow him to impede on this part of her life. Today was for André. The two of them together at last. She no longer had to check the newspaper headlines at the end of the factory shift to see if there had been Allied bombing raids on Berlin. She exhaled, grateful for this moment. He pulled back, cupping his hands on either side of her face.

“You look more beautiful than ever,” he said. “I don’t know how to thank you for getting me out of Berlin. You’ve saved my life.”

She smiled and ran her fingers through his thin hair. “I’m so happy.”

“Now, it’s my turn to look after you.”

She wanted to tell him that she didn’t need looking after, that she could take care of herself and him and Léa too. “You don’t need to.”

“This war isn’t over yet.” He looked at her and her heart quickened.

“But the end is getting closer, isn’t it?”

“Yes.” She heard him inhale sharply. “It’s also getting closer to us.”

“We’re together,” she said. “That’s all that matters.”

* * *

February had given way to March, then April, and now it was spring. Every day, at the end of her factory shift, André waited for Rose. He usually stood across the street, leaning against the wall, pretending to be reading the paper, and after she appeared, he’d follow her through the town, keeping a safe distance so no one observing would think they were together. They’d walk until they reached a narrow path that led into the woods. He’d come up from behind, whispering, *Rose*, in her ear.

It was the only time during the week they could be together—ninety minutes sandwiched between the end of her factory shift and the moment she went to the sick bay to collect the typed report for Reinhardt.

Today, Rose didn’t see him and she wondered if he might already be waiting for her at the place they’d agreed to meet. There were three spots they rotated—the forest, the old washhouse by the river, and today, the